01 | CCEs | RESOURCE

# CCEs: A Guide for Leaders and Staff

What each element means and what to write

The CCE Administrative Directive covers written direction from leadership. Staff at any level can use the same six questions to understand an assignment, ask for a missing detail, or hand off work. The CCEs do not change who has approval authority.

## What to write for each element

| | |
|---|---|
| 01 | **What is changing or being asked**<br>Say who the message is for, what they need to do, and the deadline or start date. If people need to know something on one date and act on another, list both dates. |
| 02 | **Why / Why it is changing**<br>Give the reason or the problem the work solves. “Management wants it” doesn’t tell anyone why. |
| 03 | **Who owns it and who decides**<br>Name the person who will do the work and the person who will decide. Spell out what the reader can decide on their own. |
| 04 | **What is not changing**<br>List the duties, service levels, rules, or approvals that are not affected. Check before you call anything unchanged. |
| 05 | **What to do if it is unclear, and when you will hear back**<br>Name the contact for questions and when they will reply. Escalated questions get an answer, or the name of the person handling them, within two working days. If it will take longer, say when the next update is coming. |
| 06 | **Where this lives (whenever applicable)**<br>Name the document, its version, and where to find it. If no document applies, skip this one. |

> **Every channel counts**
> Emails, chats, forwards, and reminders that give direction need the CCEs that apply. Greetings and replies that just confirm receipt don’t.

*Based on: Communicating CLEAR training, final series, slides 11–19 and 37–41.*

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# CCEs: Example and Practice

Example only. Swap in your own details.

| CCE | Example |
|---|---|
| **1. Action** | Service desk team: look over next week's draft coverage schedule and email your supervisor about any conflicts by noon Thursday. |
| **2. Reason** | We want to catch coverage gaps before the schedule is locked in. |
| **3. Owners** | You check your own availability. Your supervisor approves the final coverage plan. |
| **4. Unchanged** | Your current assignments, service hours, approved leave, and duties stay as they are until a change is approved. |
| **5. Questions and reply** | Questions go to your supervisor. Escalated questions get an answer, or the name of the person handling them, within two working days. If it takes longer, you'll get an update. |
| **6. Source** | The current coverage schedule is attached. In a real message, attach the approved file or say where it is saved. |

## Practice: draft your next message

| Use this space | Your notes |
|---|---|
| **What and by when** | |
| **Why, and who owns it** | |
| **What stays the same** | |
| **Who to ask, and source** | |

## Make sure it landed

Ask: "Just to check I was clear, what's your next step?" Listen for the task, the deadline, and who they'd go to for help. If any of those are missing, fix the message.

Rewording is fine. Changing the confirmed task, deadline, or decision-maker is not.

*Based on: Communicating CLEAR training, final series, slides 11–19 and 37–41.*